

Session 1: The Breadth of Biophilic Experiences

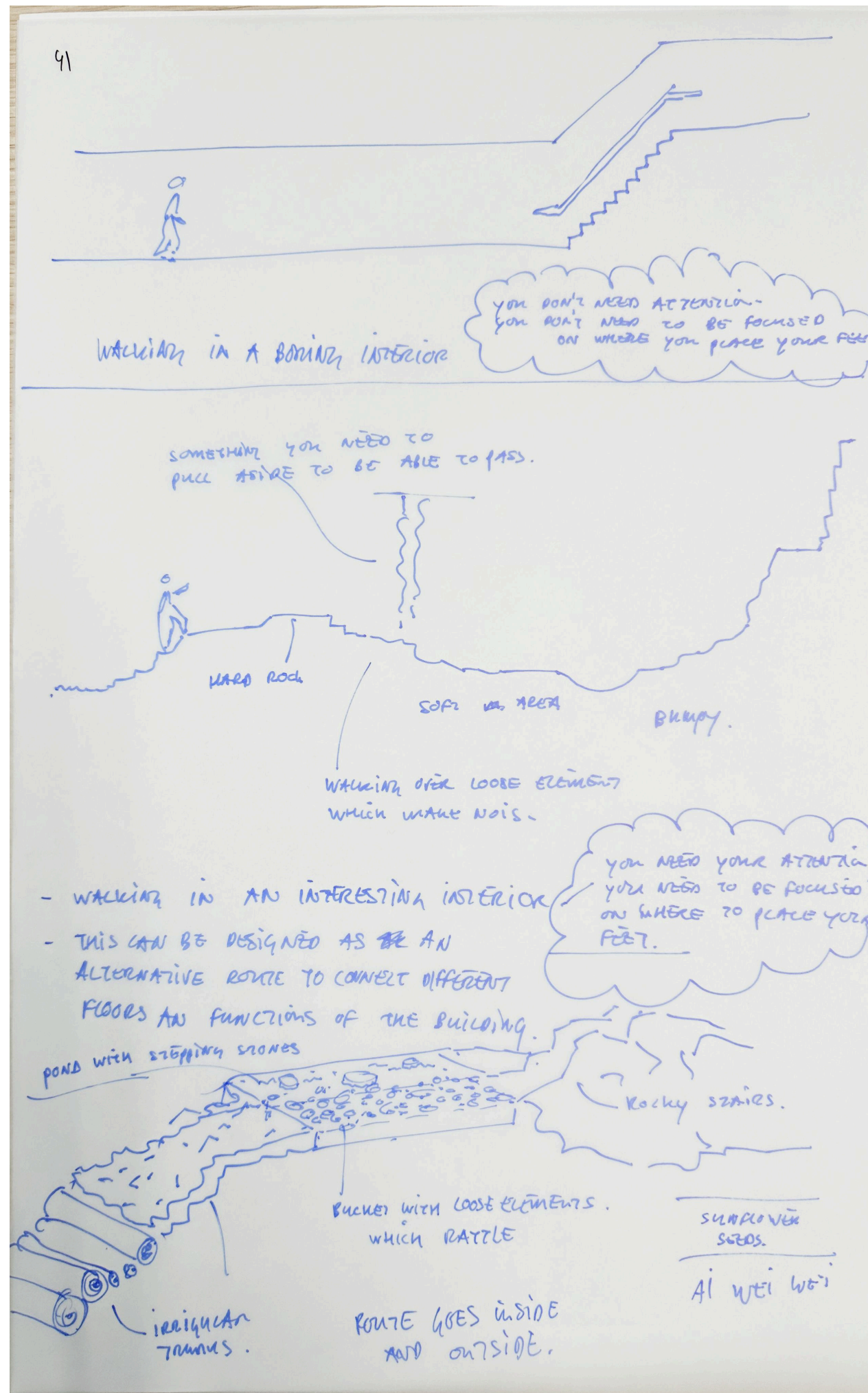
Bentham
Crouwel

4 Architects

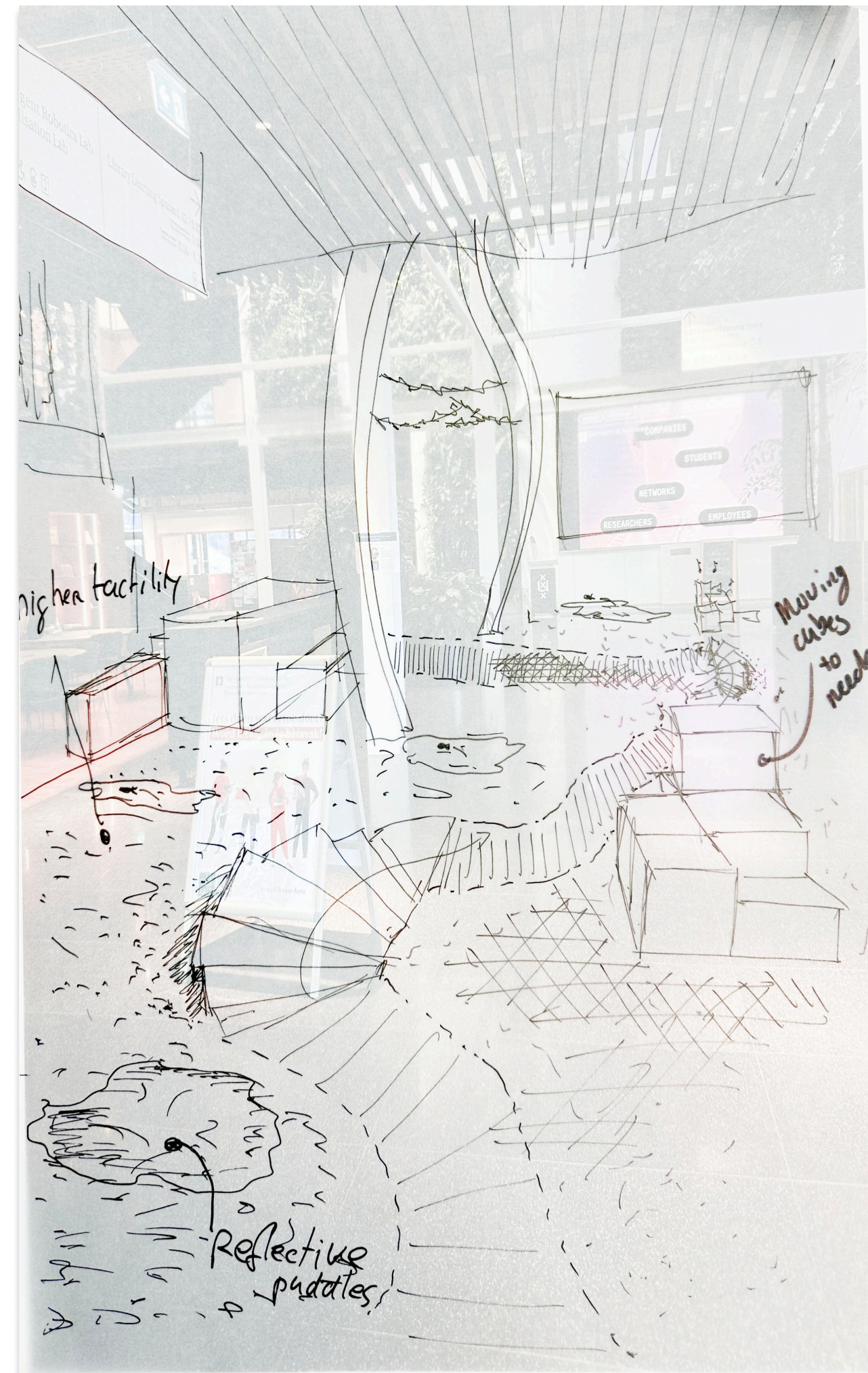
31 Jan 2025

120 mins

Aim. To identify biophilic experiential qualities that experts perceive as diminished or absent in indoor environments.



Group 1 - Final sketch of an “Active” indoor corridors for restorative experiences. Introduce varied underfoot textures, level shifts, and tactile thresholds (e.g. a curtain to part) to prompt brief embodied resets in indoor corridors.



Group 2 - Final sketch of a biophilic entryway for orientation & wayfinding experiences. Support affective wayfinding. Combine haptic feedback from walls and floors with sound cues to create “dialogic” building navigation systems.

Key Outcomes (how experienced)

- Indoor wandering experiences. Experiences of purposeless and meandering movement that invite the body to drift, linger, and explore without destination. This restores spontaneity and sensory curiosity often lost in linear indoor circulation (2, 3, 4).
- Atmospheric richness of buildings. The olfactory experiences of “freshness” and “ozonic” smells that convey the “aliveness” of nature, combined with diverse airflow patterns to capture seasonal traces to support mental clarity and sensory vitality within indoor environments (1, 7).
- “Acceptable” indoor messiness. Legible, intentional departures from expected indoor order (e.g. textural contrasts, uneven paths, shifting shadows) can capture the notion of outdoor “mess” to provoke (2, 8).
- Micro-tactile experiences. Experiences of fine-grained variation in floors that prompt careful foot placement and shifts in balance, momentarily redirecting attention from cognitive tasks (3, 5).

Session 1 informed Session 2's focus on the spatial translation and material expression of biophilic qualities.